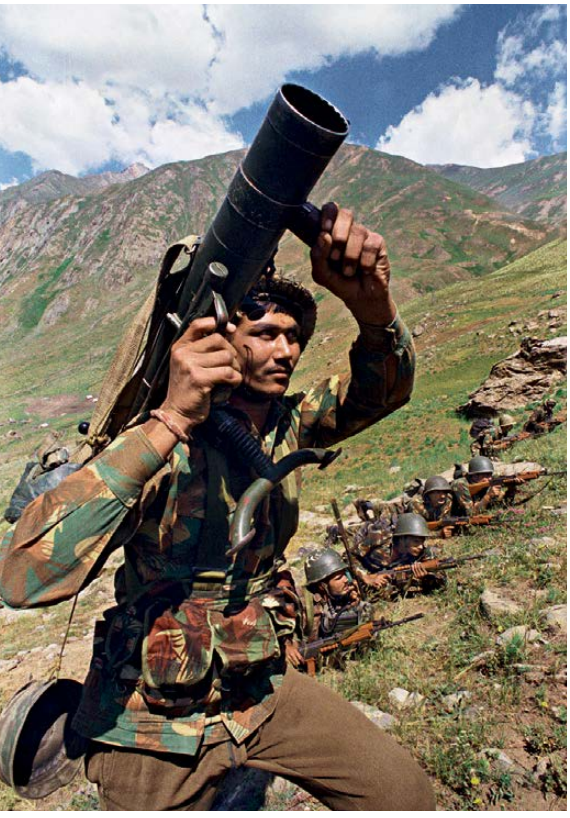
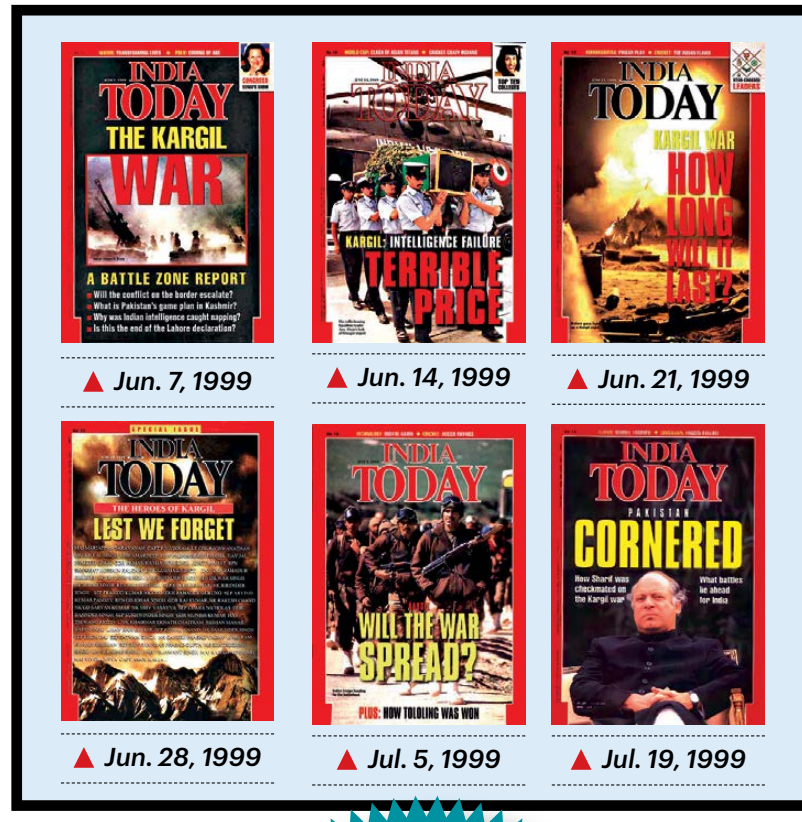
SHARAD SAXENA







PRAMOD PUSHKARNA

MILITARILY AS WELL AS DIPLOMATICALLY, INDIA'S STAND WAS VINDICATED. IT AVOIDED ESCALATING THE CONFLICT AND ALSO GAINED INTERNATIONAL SYMPATHY AS THE AGGRIEVED PARTY

SHORT-LIVED
(From above left) An Indian soldier takes aim with an RPG as his colleagues take cover; PM Vajpayee, Pakistan's Nawaz Sharif, other leaders along with actor Dev Anand at the Indo-Pak Lahore bus seva ceremony to launch the cross-border service, Feb. 1999

they were withdrawing. It took India another 20 days to clear out the Pakistani positions that had refused to stand down.

The aftereffects of the Kargil war lingered on for years. Militarily and diplomatically, India's stand was vindicated. It avoided escalating the conflict and also gained international sympathy as the aggrieved party. Meanwhile, Pakistan's actions were seen as reckless and it suffered a loss of support on the Kashmir issue. Internally, the fallout was more severe. Civil-military tensions rose and by 1999-end, another army coup had put Gen. Pervez Musharraf in charge of the country. ■